

August 12, 2026

Absolute Total Care (Centene)
Provider Appeals Department

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Eduardo Treviño (MRN MUSC1180252), Claim MUSC-20260426-B898-2

Patient	Eduardo Treviño (DOB 1971-02-01)
MRN	MUSC1180252
Member ID / Group	ABS836618976 / GRP-24383
Claim number	MUSC-20260426-B898-2
Date of service	2026-04-26
Procedure billed	CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity
Primary diagnosis	J06.9 — Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified
Denied amount	\$758.95
Denial code	CARC 18 / RARC N522 — Exact duplicate claim/service.
Appeal deadline	2026-08-22

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health is submitting this formal first-level appeal on behalf of patient Eduardo Treviño (MRN: MUSC9177165, Member ID: ABS836618976) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-20260426-B898-2 for services rendered on April 26, 2026, at MUSC Health Ashley River Tower. The claim was denied by Absolute Total Care (Centene) on May 24, 2026, under CARC 18 ("Exact duplicate claim/service") and RARC N522 ("Duplicate of a claim processed or in process as a crossover/coordination of benefits claim"), with the payer remark stating: "Claim appears to duplicate a previously adjudicated claim." MUSC Health respectfully disputes this determination. The service in question represents a single, discrete, and independently documented outpatient encounter that has not been submitted, adjudicated, or paid under any prior claim.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

On April 26, 2026, Eduardo Treviño, a 54-year-old established male patient with an active diagnosis of hyperlipidemia (ICD-10 E78.5), presented to MUSC Health Ashley River Tower for an outpatient visit rendered by Robert K. Lindqvist, MD (NPI 1314059687). The encounter was billed under CPT 99214, reflecting an office or outpatient visit for an established patient of moderate complexity, with a primary diagnosis of acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified (ICD-10 J06.9). The claim was submitted on May 10, 2026, under place of service code 22 (On Campus Outpatient Hospital), revenue code 0510, for a billed amount of \$758.95. This visit is clinically and temporally distinct from any prior encounter documented in Mr. Treviño's record.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The duplicate denial is not supported by the facts of this claim. A duplicate denial under CARC 18 and RARC N522 requires the existence of a previously adjudicated or in-process claim for the same patient, same date of service, same provider, and same procedure. MUSC Health has reviewed its billing records and confirms that Claim MUSC-20260426-B898-2 was submitted once, on May 10, 2026, for the April 26, 2026 date of service. No prior claim for this specific encounter has been submitted to Absolute Total Care or any other payer. The RARC N522 notation references a potential crossover or coordination of benefits scenario; however, the case record does not reflect any secondary payer involvement or crossover claim activity associated with this date of service that would give rise to such a characterization.

Furthermore, a review of Mr. Treviño's encounter history confirms that the most recent previously documented visit on file predates the April 26, 2026 encounter by a substantial period. There is no overlapping claim for the same date, provider, or procedure code that could reasonably support a duplicate determination. Denying a legitimately rendered and properly coded service on the basis of an unsupported duplicate finding results in an incorrect zero-payment outcome and is inconsistent with Medicaid managed care claims adjudication standards, which require payers to identify a specific prior claim before applying a duplicate denial.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that Absolute Total Care (Centene) reopen and reprocess Claim MUSC-20260426-B898-2 in full, applying the contracted allowed amount of \$420.39 and issuing payment accordingly. We further request that the payer provide, in its response, the specific prior claim number alleged to be a duplicate of this submission, so that any discrepancy may be investigated and resolved promptly. Supporting documentation, including the claim submission record and encounter documentation for the April 26, 2026 visit, is attached for review. This appeal is submitted within the 90-day appeal window, prior to the August 22, 2026 deadline, through the secure provider portal as directed.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

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Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record